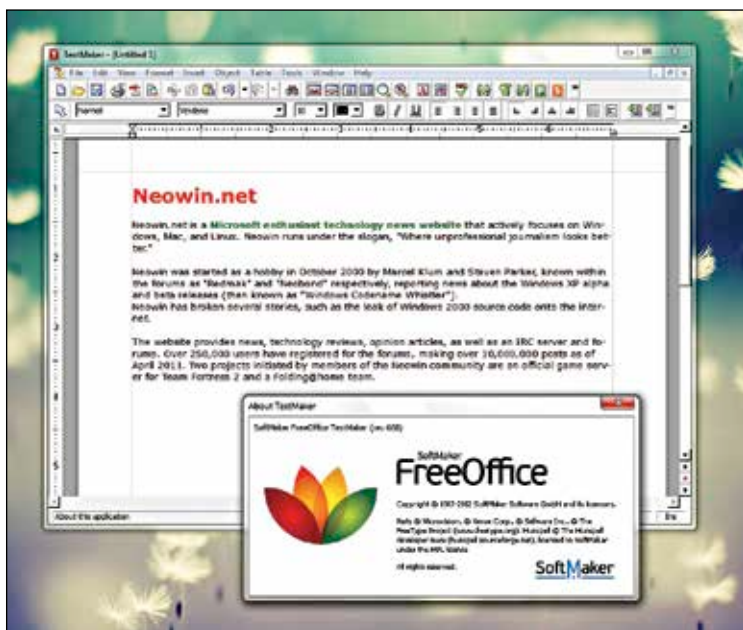


including 'TextMaker' (word processing), 'PlanMaker' (spreadsheet making), 'Presentations' and 'BasicMaker' (a visual basic programming tool). The Pro version of the software has more features and tools such as an integrated email client and a full German dictionary. Its multi-language support systems are one of its key offerings in the European market.

Despite the restrictions in the free versions, it functions admirably well in most aspects with close approximation to the tools that most people need. The comparison of SoftMaker FreeOffice with other freely available office suites has in recent years placed it significantly ahead of the competition. This is due to its greater compatibility with Microsoft-based files which other open source systems have been shown to struggle with, based on user response. In addition, the user interface has proven to be far more desirable than other open source based office suites.

History and development

The conceptualisation and development of SoftMaker office suites began in the late 1980s before the company SoftMaker was even incorporated. The



The SoftMaker office suite